

Spotify has an official (native) desktop client for Ubuntu/Linux music fans, but there has been no announcement of any such plan for Ubuntu for phones/tablet versions. Cute Spotify is a free app and can also be installed from the Click App Store Scope. This option is available for Jolla's Sailfish OS too.

Linux Mint Debian Edition is in the making

The Linux Mint team has offered the Linux Mint 17.1 'Rebecca' release for both the MATE and Cinnamon desktops. Now it seems that the Debian edition will be a lot more interesting.

Usually, Linux Mint distros are based on Ubuntu, and there is no change on the cards with respect to this. But the development team has tried out the other variants like Debian. Ubuntu is based on Debian and so this would not be very difficult.

Linux Mint developers will be able to program their releases as per a precise Ubuntu release schedule. It means the Debian edition of Linux Mint is in the works and is expected very soon.



Clement Lefebvre, founder of Linux Mint, posted in his blog, "The decision was made to use GTK 3.14 in LMDE 2 'Betsy' (the same

version as in Debian Jessie). Themes and parts of Cinnamon will be adapted to work properly with it. The decision to switch to systemd or to continue to use sysvinit has not yet been taken."

RHEL 7.2 switches to the latest GNOME 3.14 version

When it comes to news about the latest developments, Red Hat Enterprise Linux does not feature too high on the list. The developers of this operating system have always believed that old is stable, though that is not always the case. Latest reports have suggested that RHEL 7.2 is switching to the latest GNOME 3.14 version. The RHEL desktop usually looks quite dated, and developers maintain the old looks for users who are not fond of changes and prefer to hold on to what they're familiar with. So now, the big question is how this community will respond to the latest developments regarding GNOME 3.14.

GNOME comes with Fedora, by default. The new features introduced in Fedora have been integrated in the RHEL edition after quite a long time, since those behind the former, strive for stability. This is true for the desktop environment too, which still works with GNOME 2, which is unquestionably quite an old version.

The desktop environment is one of the most important components of a Linux distro. The leader of the GNOME project, Matthias Clasen, has said that Red Hat Enterprise Linux has been redesigned with the latest GNOME version and this will be out very soon. The bug report is called 'Rebase to 3.14.6'. There has been no announcement regarding the launch of RHEL 7.2, as of now, though.

Android Auto finally to debut in 2015

The latest reports claim that Google's Android Auto will be launched in 2015, along with the launch of Android M. Android Auto is software for cars, which will let users access the Internet even without a smartphone. This software

Microsoft's WorldWide Telescope (WWT) project is open source now!

Microsoft started the WorldWide Telescope (WWT) project in 2007, and the company has now announced that it is open sourcing the project. The WWT project started as a collaborative institutional programme to visualise the universe, and let even laymen and hobbyists explore the 'multi-spectral imagery' for free.

Now, after eight years, the scope of the WWT mission is to be further expanded by making it open source so that more ways can be explored to use all the information in educational projects worldwide. The programme has been described as a fabulous one, since it offers tutorials on various related topics. If you just right-click on a constellation, galaxy or a planet, you can access its entire database, which includes information from sources ranging from Wikipedia to astronomy encyclopedia. These discussions are described as 'Guided Tours'. The programme also narrates information on stellar formation, the detection of planets, etc.

Microsoft has advanced a lot in terms of 'openness' in the last two years and now this push to open source the WWT project makes its position stronger in the open source community. Last year, Microsoft open sourced .NET, and it is also producing an office suite for Android and iOS. CEO Satya Nadella has realised the importance of promoting such products, which makes sense for both the company and consumers.

It is too early to predict the future of the WWT project but if you're interested in Mars images, photos of other planets and a virtual 3D tour of the entire solar system, then this is an excellent option. The programme can be viewed via a standalone application and also through a browser. It's not certain when exactly the open source version of the programme will be released as the company is still working on its code and features.